images helps Freed calibrate the social distances between him and his subjects, remapping the border and other dividing lines in the process.

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In the years between the composition of his photographs and the production of *Black in White America*, the United States experienced a tumultuous back-end pendulum swing of social change. Protest movements helped to achieve serious legislative gains in the form of 1964's Civil Rights Act and 1965's Voting Rights Act. But in 1968, the year of the book's publication, Freed's vision of a divided nation was echoed in the government-sponsored *Report* of the Kerner Commission, which famously stated that America was "moving toward two societies, one black, one white—separate and unequal."[43] Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., who was at the height of his popularity and influence after the March on Washington and being awarded the Nobel Prize, had become marginalized for his outspoken opposition to the Vietnam War and his work on behalf of unions and the poor. King was assassinated in Memphis on April 4, 1968, while campaigning for striking sanitation workers. The same sort of social unrest caused by systemic repression and brutality that the Kerner Commission investigated reescalated and exploded in more than 100 American cities after King's assassination. The slow drag of integration persisted. With military escalation in Vietnam, the assassination of Robert F. Kennedy, and new waves of social unrest, the efforts to fight the civil rights–era divisions in American society would be overshadowed by an added set of challenges. In West Germany, the welcome exchanges of "America's Berlin," faltered through increased protest aimed at confronting U.S. militarism.[44] These protests were fueled by transatlantic alliances among student activists. In American public spaces, examples of persistent segregation and reluctant integration were common fodder for court cases and protests.

During these same years, Freed found an elevated place for himself in international photography circles. His inclusion in *The Concerned Photographer*, a traveling exhibition that opened in 1967 at New York City's Riverside Museum, put his work in shared context with established photography greats such as Robert Capa and André Kertész. Freed continued to travel through Europe, Israel, and Japan over the following years, affirming his global reach toward the end of the decade, as he prepared to move away from Europe with his family and back to New York City. He